

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Actual Day-14 Notice of Appeal

Filed: March 11, 2026 **Synthetic district docket:** SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 **Public docket entry:** DE45

Notice is hereby given that Mateo Serrano appeals to the United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit from the criminal judgment entered February 25, 2026, and from the sentence and antecedent rulings merged into that judgment. This notice is filed with the district clerk on March 11, the fourteenth day after entry of judgment.

The appeal includes review to the extent permitted by the plea agreement and governing law. The notice itself does not brief the scope of the appeal waiver, decide the preserved allocution carve-out, or state the merits of the aggravating-role objection. Those questions, if raised, belong in the appellate proceeding.

The district clerk is requested to enter this notice, transmit the required case-opening information, and preserve the access designations for sealed presentence-related volumes. No protected attachment accompanies the public notice. This filing does not disclose a presentence report, personal identifier, account, credential, or operational detail of the fictional offense.

Judgment and Record Identified

The judgment being appealed is DE41, entered February 25, 2026. Related public entries include the February 24 sentencing transcript at DE37, the public minute and reasons summary at DE38, the role-objection order at DE39, and the Rule 32(j) notice at DE40.

The sentence is 36 months of imprisonment, three years of supervised release, restitution of \$186,400, a \$100 assessment, and no fine. Identifying those terms does not concede that every potential claim is outside or inside the written waiver. Serrano preserves all positions allowed by the plea text, including its express treatment of complete denial of a personal opportunity to allocute.

Celia Arden files this notice for Serrano. It is sufficient to identify the appealing party and judgment; later submissions may define issues within lawful limits. The notice does not request a stay, predict relief, or assert that the district judgment has been altered. It invokes the ordinary appellate process while leaving issue definition to later filings and lawful court directions.

Signature, Service, and Clerk Entry

Celia Arden, Federal Defender Exercise Office for the Middle District of North Carolina, signs this notice for Mateo Serrano on March 11, 2026. The signature is fictional and supplies no real bar number, address, telephone number, email account, or electronic filing credential.

Arden certifies service the same day on Bram Ives of the Synthetic United States Attorney's Office through the district court's training channel. Niko Faye receives an administrative docket notification solely for record preparation. No sealed document is attached or served publicly.

Tessa Wren enters the filing as DE45 after the docket report certified earlier that day. The clerk will send case-opening information and a certified record index to the fictional Fourth Circuit exercise clerk. This notice was not deposited under a prison-mail procedure and does not depend on an earlier tender date; it was filed directly with the district clerk on day 14.

The filing is a synthetic exercise instrument and cannot commence a real appeal. It states no later appellate docket event, no judicial result, and no disposition of the conviction or sentence.